opportunity to ingratiate himself with them by giving them unauthorised information. He even went to the extent of removing certain papers from official files to which he had easy access and passing them on to defending lawyers.'

Again, in Korea as a brigadier, Kaul was on Thimayya's staff and worked with Thorat in a subordinate position: 'There Kaul had emerged as an ardent admirer of communism and seriously embarrassed Timmy and me by his partiality towards the communist prisoners.' Yet again as a major general commanding 4 Division, he had Thorat as his corps commander. Almost each and every time, despite Kaul's political connections, Thorat would diligently put down on paper that in his opinion, Kaul had reached the limits of his professional competence. Thorat would write later: 'Having known him for so long and so well, I am in a position to assess his good and bad points. On the credit side he was above average in intelligence and had immense drive. He was a tireless worker and good speaker though given to unnecessary dramatization. On the debit side lay his unbridled ambition—in the pursuit of which he was ruthless.' In an army where one bad report usually seals a man's fate, Nehru's intervention kept Kaul's flag flying.

It is interesting to see how the Chinese read Bijji Kaul. General Yang Chengiou, the Deputy Chief of General Staff, had led a PLA team to India in 1957. Apart from visiting ordnance factories and a host of other establishments, 4 Infantry Division (of which Kaul was then the GOC) had put on a demonstration on Indian Army infantry tactics somewhere near Ambala. In a subsequent meeting in Peking, Chairman Mao had asked Yang Chengiou to brief the assembled Chinese leadership on his perception of Kaul.

> Five years ago, I led a military delegation to India. Kaul was then commander of the 4th Division. When he was young he had graduated from the Royal British Military College at Sandhurst. He had probably participated in war in Burma during World War II but he probably has no experience of a real war. His colleagues ridicule him as a General who has never fought a war. During our visit the reason why he put on a demonstration of tactical offensive was, from one point of view, for building up his own image…
>
> …at that time, the demonstration was very well conceived, very tight, as if there was nothing left out. But precisely because of this, I felt that it very much resembled a staged play. Every little detail of whole plan was held in his head. On this point, I admired his intelligence and meticulousness. I did not have much contact with Kaul but generally felt that he was a determined and sensitive person. He was inclined to listen to the opinion of his officials and soldiers but not to those of the Generals. That was the fatal flaw in him. He liked music, plays, trekking; he often went on inspection tours of posts in the snow-bound Ji-Jie high mountains. He has experienced danger on quite a few occasions. Those who like him call him